

TidyTuesday Week 37

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Monday 7th September, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the corner of the internet where we throw two unrelated economic time series into a blender and act surprised when a smoothie comes out. This week was a lean one – a single pairing, but oh, what a pairing. We matched up the “Discussion About Pandemics Index for Lithuania” with the U.S. Treasury’s “Means of Financing: Borrowing from the Public.” Because obviously, when Lithuanians start chatting about pandemics, someone at the Treasury Department reaches for the borrowing lever. It’s just common sense.

Now, here’s the part where I’m contractually obligated to feign shock: it actually held up. The raw regression came back significant, with an R-squared of about 0.20, which for this project is practically a marriage proposal. But we’ve all been burned before – the raw version just tells you two lines wandered upward together like strangers who happened to take the same escalator. The real test is the detrended version, and, well, be still my heart, it survived. R-squared dipped only slightly to around 0.17 and the p-value stayed comfortably in “statistician nods approvingly” territory. When you strip out the shared drift and the relationship refuses to die, that’s the rare, genuinely intriguing case this project usually only dreams about while dunking on trend mirages.

So let me put on my Very Serious Analyst hat and theorize wildly: perhaps global pandemic chatter – even the Lithuanian variety – is a faint tremor of the same worldwide anxiety that eventually shows up as governments borrowing gobs of money. A shared vibe, if you will. Two seemingly random series both twitching to the beat of the same nervous drum. It’s almost profound. It’s almost meaningful. It’s almost enough to make you forget how we got here.

But let’s keep our heads. These are randomly paired series, selected by a script with no wisdom and no agenda, and I am making exactly zero causal or rigorous claims. Spurious correlation is the house special around here – the norm, not the exception – and even a detrended survivor is more “huh, neat” than “call the Nobel committee.” Enjoy the coincidence responsibly, and do not, under any circumstances, base your fiscal policy on Lithuanian pandemic small talk. See you next week for more statistically dubious speed dating.

2 Date: 2026-09-07

Series ID: WPDILTU

This series is titled Discussion About Pandemics Index for Lithuania and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1996-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: MTSMFBP133FMS

This series is titled Means of Financing: Borrowing from the Public and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2010-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 14.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_MTSMFBP133FMS	R-squared:	0.199			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.186			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	15.87			
Date:	Mon, 07 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.000176			
Time:	16:43:46	Log-Likelihood:	-893.46			
No. Observations:	66	AIC:	1791.			
Df Residuals:	64	BIC:	1795.			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	4.886e+04	2.46e+04	1.985	0.051	-321.644	9.8e+04
value_fred_WPDILTU	1205.6312	302.613	3.984	0.000	601.092	1810.170
Omnibus:	51.230	Durbin-Watson:	2.093			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	275.412			
Skew:	2.139	Prob(JB):	1.57e-60			
Kurtosis:	12.047	Cond. No.	87.5			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

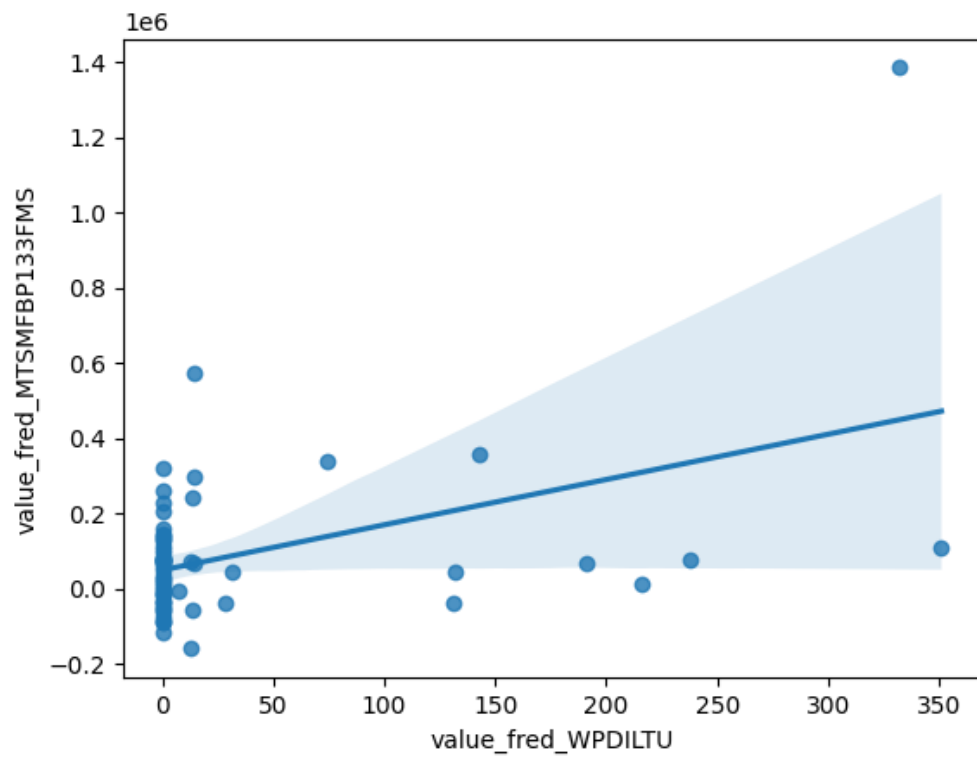


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-07

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_MTSMFBP133FMS_detrended	R-squared:	0.174
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.161
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	13.48
Date:	Mon, 07 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.000493
Time:	16:43:46	Log-Likelihood:	-893.06
No. Observations:	66	AIC:	1790.
Df Residuals:	64	BIC:	1794.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t 	[0.025	0.975]
const	5.051e-09	2.28e+04	2.22e-13	1.000	-4.55e+04	4.55e+04
value_fred_WPDILTU_detrended	1138.7087	310.105	3.672	0.000	519.204	1758.214

Omnibus:	52.012	Durbin-Watson:	2.129
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	302.597
Skew:	2.138	Prob(JB):	1.96e-66
Kurtosis:	12.579	Cond. No.	73.4

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

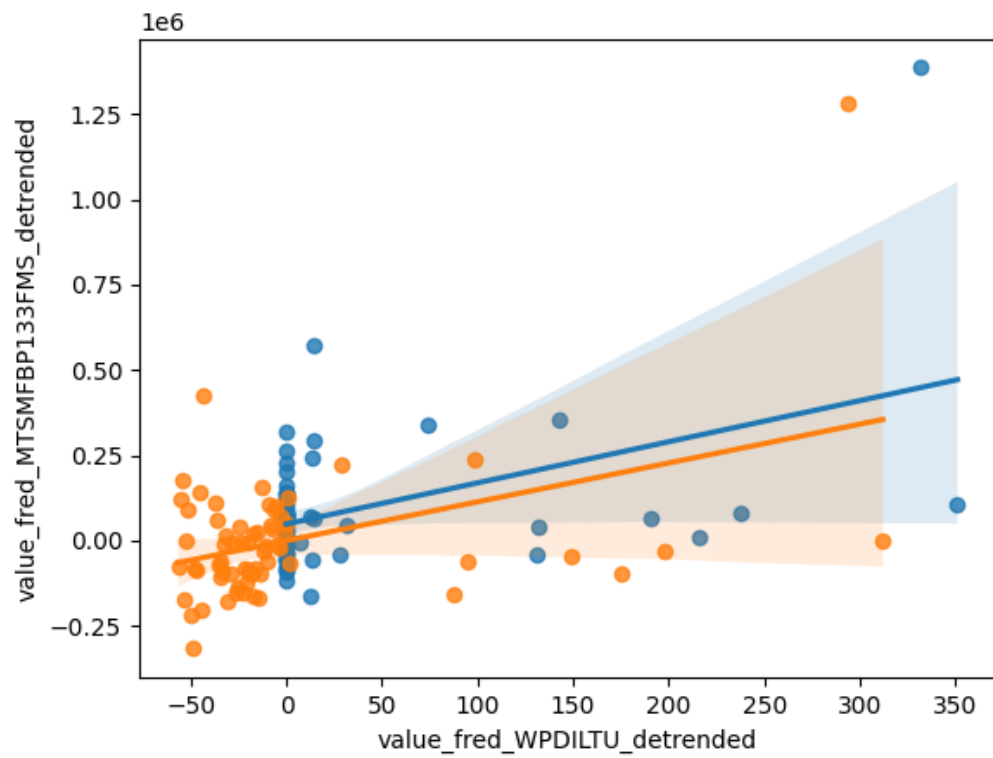


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-07